

VILLAGE CHURCH BELL (A descriptive pibroch) THE PIPER ON THE HILL-SIDE IMITATES THE BELL

By J. D. R. WATT

To get the Bell note correctly in regular even rhythm throughout, it should be played "Tonn-don-ong," to get the right effect of a single bell

109

1 *bis*

Tonn don ong . . . Tonn don ong . . .

bis

twice 1st time || 2nd time

1 *bis*

Tonn don ong on . . . Tonn don ong on . . .

bis

2 *bis*

Tonn don ong . . . Tonn don ong . . .

The musical score is written for a single melodic line in treble clef, 2/4 time. It consists of three systems of staves. The first system (measures 109-118) begins with a first ending bracket labeled '1' and 'bis', followed by a section marked 'twice 1st time || 2nd time'. The second system (measures 119-128) starts with a first ending bracket labeled '1' and 'bis'. The third system (measures 129-138) begins with a first ending bracket labeled '2' and 'bis'. The rhythmic pattern is based on the 'Tonn-don-ong' triplet, which is used to imitate the sound of a bell. The notation includes various note values (quarter, eighth, and sixteenth notes) and rests to create the desired rhythmic effect.



5. *bis*

Tonn don ong Tonn don ong

bis

The musical score consists of four staves of music in treble clef. The first staff is a single line of music. The second staff begins with a bracketed section labeled '5. bis' and contains the lyrics 'Tonn don ong Tonn don ong'. The third and fourth staves continue the musical sequence, with the third staff also featuring a bracketed section labeled 'bis'.

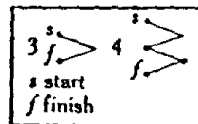
THE VILLAGE CHURCH BELL

A Piper friend of the writer, who spent his boyhood days "within sound" of three Highland church-bells learnt their "song," which has remained with him all his life. Now the ringing of a church bell is an art, and needs to be learnt, and the knack or trick of it acquired; One reason for the remembrance of the same being the occasion of the appearance of a new bell-ringer when the whole countryside around knew the difference and laughed at his efforts.

Start with 'Ton don ong' for a while, making a 'Torluath' of three notes of it. Then pulling harder it becomes 'Ton don on ong'; When it is in full swing the last beat, *ong* in each case, is long, and starts to die out in each case before the next *Ton* accent. When it is in full swing it is 'Ton don Ton don'. The accented beats proving the 'Torluath' correct. A good player can change from one set of beats to another at will! Some manage to get in an extra small beat of the 4 note beat like 'Ton Ton don onn on'. The pulling has to be timed exactly. The ringer does not look up but goes by sound.

To follow the bell-clapper with the eye (as an experiment), stick a small white feather on the end of the clapper, then hold the Bell over the mirror as in the 4-note movement the clapper moves too fast for the unaided eye. In the 3-note movement the clapper strikes once on the impulse side and once on the opposite side—once again on the impulse side. In the 4-note movement it strikes three times on impulse side and once on the opposite side. As the rim of the bell is swinging in space the clapper does not strike the rim of the

bell in the spot in space as is shown here at *s. f.*



scientific facts and one also knows the correct bell note by ear.